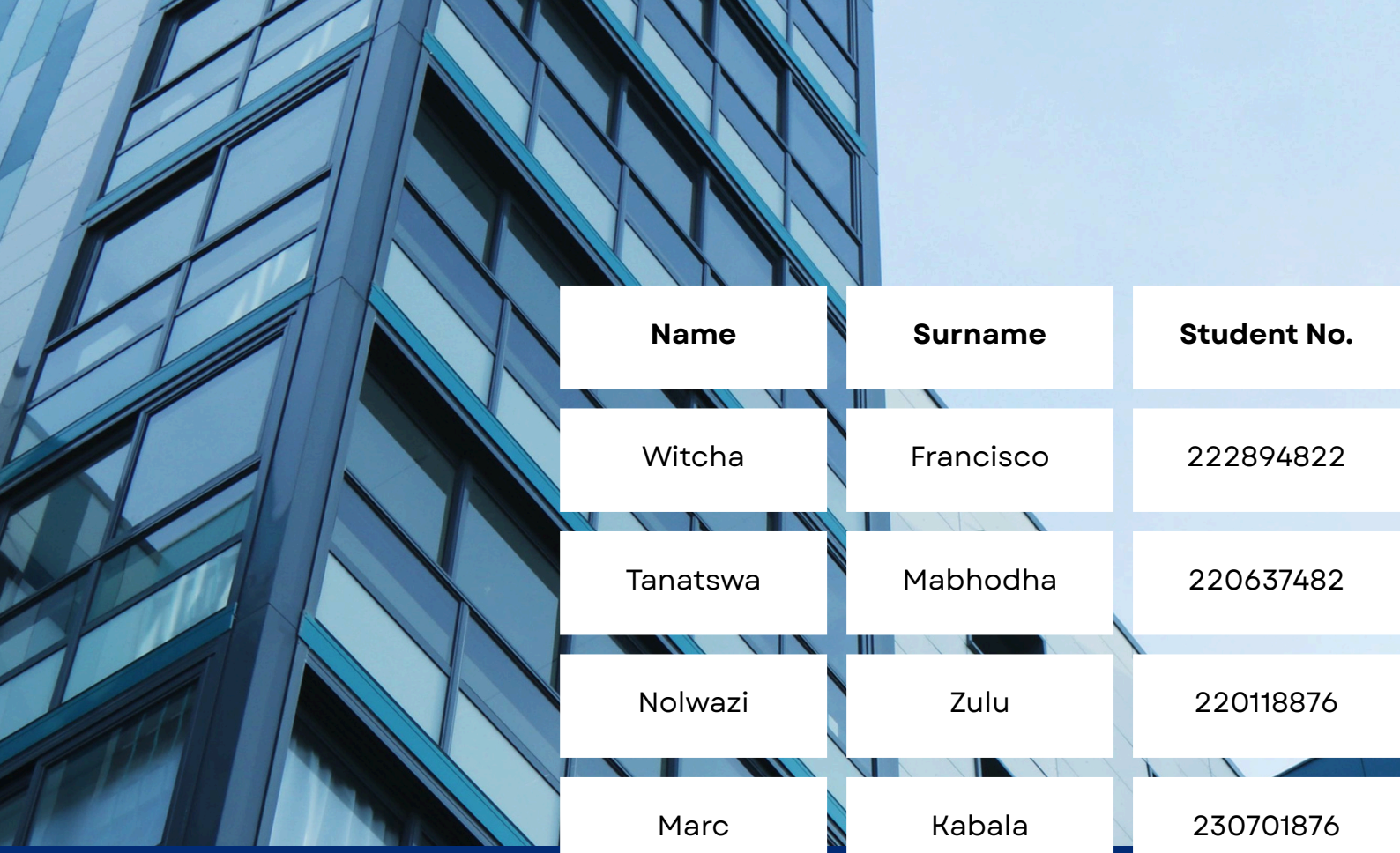


Name	Surname	Student No.
Witcha	Francisco	222894822
Tanatswa	Mabhodha	220637482
Nolwazi	Zulu	220118876
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NAVIGSA

NAVIGATE SA - STUDENT APPLICATION SERVICES

PRP372S
PROJECT PRESENTATION 3

Prepared for
Prima Inderlal

NavigSA.

13 March 2026

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Team Expertise



Witcha Francisco
Editor



Nolwazi Zulu
Present / Team Leader



Marc Kabala
Designer



Tanatswa Mabhodha
Researcher

Team Purpose

Objective

The NavigSA team exists to design and validate a business concept that addresses a clearly identified gap in the South African higher education landscape: the difficulty faced by international students from non-English-speaking countries when navigating the SAQA evaluation, university application, study visa, and accommodation processes. Through structured research, community engagement, and professional business planning, the team aims to deliver a credible, evidence-based Professional Practice 3 assignment that demonstrates real-world problem-solving capability.

Vision Statement

"To be the most trusted navigator for international students entering South Africa's tertiary education system, removing barriers of language, confusion, and exploitation through affordable, multilingual, and step-by-step guidance."

Team Roles and Responsibilities

Marc Kabala – Designer (UI/UX & Visual Communication Lead)
Responsible for translating the NavigSA concept into a clear, engaging, and professional visual experience. Led the design of presentation slides, report layout, and branding elements to ensure consistency across all deliverables. Applied user-centered design principles to simplify complex processes (such as SAQA and visa steps) into visually understandable flows. Contributed to improving user engagement by designing structured, easy-to-follow interfaces and visual storytelling elements used in the final presentation and documentation.

Individual Contribution - Marc Kabala (Designer)

As the Designer, my primary responsibility was to ensure that all project outputs were visually clear, professional, and user-friendly. I focused on transforming complex research and technical processes into simple, understandable visual formats.

My key contributions included:

- Designing the overall visual identity of NavigSA (color consistency, layout, typography)
- Creating the presentation slides used in the final pitch
- Structuring the PFP report layout to improve readability and flow
- Converting research insights into visual elements (tables, sections, hierarchy)
- Supporting the team by simplifying user journeys into step-by-step visual flows
- Ensuring the final deliverables met professional and academic design standards

Through my role, I helped bridge the gap between raw research and user understanding, making the NavigSA solution more accessible and impactful.

Team Values and Principles

Core Values

- Collaboration: Every team member contributes meaningfully. We share ideas, support each other, and make decisions collectively.
- Respect: We honour each team member's time, opinions, and cultural background. Disagreements are handled professionally.
- Transparency: We communicate openly about progress, challenges, and availability. There are no surprises at submission time.
- Accountability: Each member takes ownership of their assigned tasks and delivers on commitments made to the team.
- Excellence: We hold our work to a high standard, ensuring every section of our deliverables reflects genuine effort and critical thinking.
- Empathy: Reflecting the mission of NavigSA itself, we approach our community research with genuine care for the people we are studying.
- We prioritise clarity in communication, ensuring that information is not only accurate but also visually understandable, led by the design approach applied in our deliverables.

Agile Principles We Follow

- Individuals and interactions over processes and tools: We prioritise open conversation and teamwork above rigid workflows.
- Working deliverables over comprehensive documentation: We focus on producing complete, high-quality sections iteratively rather than planning everything up front.
- We collaborate with our community: Our validation interviews show our commitment to understanding real user needs.
- Responding to change: We adapt our business idea and report structure based on feedback from interviews and from our lecturer.
- Continuous improvement: After each milestone, we reflect on what worked and what could be improved.

Communication Plan

Communication Channels

Channel	Purpose	Frequency
WhatsApp Group	Daily check-ins, quick updates, sharing resources and links	As needed
Teams Meeting	Sharing work and when we need feedback	As needed
In-person Meetings	Sprint planning, task assignment, progress review, and problem-solving	Weekly (minimum)
Email	Formal communication with the lecturer or external stakeholders	Throughout the project

Communication Channels

- Meetings are scheduled at least 48 hours in advance.
- An agenda is circulated before each meeting via WhatsApp.
- One team member takes notes during each meeting and shares a summary within 24 hours.
- Decisions made in meetings are logged in the shared Google Doc.
- Absent members must review the meeting summary and confirm receipt within 24 hours.

Decision Making

Routine decisions are made by majority agreement in the team chat. Major decisions, such as changing the business idea or the report structure, require a full team discussion in person or via video call. The Team Leader (Nolwazi Zulu) has a casting vote in the event of a deadlock.

Goals and Milestones

SMART Goals

The following goals have been agreed upon by the team to guide our work on the NavigSA project:

Goal	SMART Criteria Met	Timeline	Success Indicator
Complete community selection & problem identification	Specific, Measurable	Week 1–2	Identify and document community, validated through 8 interviews
Conduct 8 problem validation interviews	Specific, Measurable, Achievable	Week 3	Interviews completed with P1–P8; insights documented
Define business idea and value proposition	Specific, Relevant	Week 4	NavigSA business concept fully articulated
Complete full PFP report draft	Measurable, Time-bound	Week 5	13-page report submitted to lecturer for review
Present findings to Bhadra Ranchod	Specific, Time-bound	13 March 2026	Presentation delivered; all team members participate
Finalize Agile Team Charter	Specific, Measurable, Time-bound	Week 5	Charter submitted with all required components

Project Milestones

Key milestones that mark the completion of major phases in our project:

#	Milestone	Target Date
M1	Community Selection Approved	Week 1
M2	Problem Identification Complete	Week 2
M3	8 Validation Interviews Conducted	Week 3
M4	Business Idea & Services Defined	Week 4
M5	Full Report Draft Completed	Week 4-5
M6	Agile Team Charter Submitted	Week 5
M7	Final Presentation Delivered	13 March 2026

Working Agreements

The following agreements have been made collectively by all team members to ensure smooth collaboration throughout the project:

- All work must be submitted to the shared folder at least 24 hours before the group deadline for review.
- No section will be submitted to the lecturer unless all team members have reviewed and approved it.
- If a team member is unable to complete their task by the agreed deadline, they must notify the team at least 48 hours in advance so responsibilities can be redistributed.
- Feedback from the lecturer is reviewed collectively, and changes are assigned in the next sprint planning session.
- Credit for work is acknowledged openly, we do not claim each other's contributions.
- Conflicts are addressed directly between the parties involved first; if unresolved, the Team Leader mediates.
- We commit to producing work that is our own and uphold academic integrity at all times.

Sprint Structure (Agile Approach)

Our team adopted a lightweight Agile sprint approach to manage the project across the available timeframe. Each sprint is approximately one week long, with a defined focus area and deliverable.

Sprint	Week	Focus Area	Key Output
1	Week 1	Team formation & community selection	Community Selection section completed
2	Week 2	Problem identification & background research	Problem Identification section; literature review
3	Week 3	Primary research & interviews	8 interviews conducted; Problem Validation table
4-5	Week 4-5	Business idea definition & service design	Business Idea, Services, Approach, Value Proposition
6	Week 6	Report compilation, visual design finalisation & submission (led by Designer – Marc Kabala)	Full report submitted; Agile Team Charter finalised

Design Impact Statement

The design of NavigSA played a critical role in ensuring that complex processes such as SAQA evaluation, university applications, and visa steps were presented in a simple and structured way. By focusing on clarity, layout, and user experience, the Designer ensured that both the report and presentation were not only informative but also easy to understand and engaging for the audience.

Team Agreement & Sign-Off

By acknowledging this charter, each team member confirms that they have read, understood, and agreed to abide by the goals, roles, values, and working agreements set out in this document.

Team Member	Role	Acknowledgement
Nolwazi Zulu	Present / Team Leader	I agree to this charter
Witcha Francisco	Editor / Researcher	I agree to this charter
Tanatswa Mabhodha	Researcher / Editor	I agree to this charter
Marc Kabala	Designer	I agree to this charter



THE END

NavigSA Project Charter (Researcher)
Module: PRP – Project Presentation
Role: Researcher
Student Name: Tanatswa Mabhodha
Student Number: 220637482
Date: 04 May

1. Role Overview
As the researcher in the NavigSA project, I am responsible for ensuring that all decisions, features, and solutions are based on accurate data and real user needs. My role focuses on understanding the challenges faced by international students and translating those findings into actionable insights for the team.

2. Research Purpose
The purpose of my role is to provide reliable, evidence-based insights that guide the design and development of the NavigSA platform. This ensures that the solution directly addresses real problems experienced by users.

3. Key Responsibilities
In this role, I conduct primary research through interviews with international students and analyse qualitative data to identify patterns and insights. I research SAQA evaluation processes and requirements, investigate university application procedures in South Africa, and examine study visa processes and documentation requirements. I also identify risks such as fraud, document errors, and delays, support feature definition using research findings, and ensure that multilingual needs are considered in the solution.

4. Research Activities Completed
Several key research activities were completed during this process. These include defining the problem statement based on initial research, conducting and analysing interviews with multiple participants, and identifying key user pain points such as language barriers and lack of guidance. I also researched SAQA and university application processes, contributed to the development of the user journey, and identified risks affecting international students.

5. Deliverables
The deliverables produced from this work include a research report with findings and insights, a validated problem statement, a user needs analysis, process research for SAQA, applications, and visas, and input into system requirements and the user journey.

6. Stakeholder Contribution
My contribution to stakeholders involved providing research insights to support the design

and development team, ensuring that user needs remained central to all decisions, and supporting the team with accurate and relevant information.

7. Risks and Mitigation

Several risks were identified along with mitigation strategies. Limited access to participants was addressed by using online communities. Inaccurate information was mitigated by relying on official sources. Language barriers were reduced through the use of simplified communication.

8. Success Criteria

The success of this research role is measured by clearly defined research findings, the accuracy and relevance of insights, alignment between system features and user needs, and the overall contribution of research to the final solution.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the research conducted for the NavigSA platform plays a critical role in ensuring that the final solution is user-centered, accurate, and effective. By grounding decisions in reliable data and real user experiences, the platform is better positioned to address the challenges faced by international students and provide meaningful support throughout their academic journey in South Africa.